
Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board

30 June 2017

WDID: 5A250102001

Ron Sherer, District Manager
California Pines Community Services District
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Alturas, CA 96101

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AMENDMENT TO NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY

WATER QUALITY ORDER 2014-0153-DWQ-R5176, GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR SMALL DOMESTIC WASTEWATER TREATMENT SYSTEMS, CALIFORNIA PINES COMMUNITY SERVICES DISTRICT, MODOC COUNTY

On 25 May 2017 the California Pines Community Services District (hereafter "Discharger") submitted a letter request to the Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Valley Water Board) to temporarily land-apply partially treated effluent from its wastewater facility. The Central Valley Water Board regulates the wastewater treatment and disposal facility, located on County Road 71 nine miles southwest of Alturas, under General Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems Order 2014-0153-DWQ-R5176 (General Order).

Based on the site inspection and a case file review, the facility treats and disposes of less than 100,000 gallons of wastewater per day, and was enrolled under the General Order on 2 December 2014. Land application of treated wastewater was permitted under previous WDRs, but was not used and this provision was later omitted from the NOA that was issued on 2 December 2014.

The 25 May 2017 communication with the Discharger included the following changes in scope to the Facility's current General Order coverage:

- Temporary spray irrigation of partially treated water from final sewage stabilization ponds 4 and 5 to an adjacent field for disposal purposes only. No crop irrigation or grazing is planned on the land in question. The proposed application area is bermed and has a tailwater recovery system.
- Proposed temporary land application will begin in July 2017 and cease by 1 October 2017. The Discharger's primary objective is to lower water levels in the treatment ponds to repair berms damaged last winter in partial flooding conditions.

The General Order prescribes mandatory discharge and monitoring requirements shown in Information Sheet C. Sampling, monitoring, and reporting requirements applicable to your treatment and disposal methods must be completed in accordance with the appropriate treatment system sections of the *General Order* and the attached *Monitoring and Reporting Program* (MRP). With the added scope of operations, Central Valley Water Board staff has developed an amended MRP specific to your facility's operations. Please find the MRP attached to this letter.

KARL E. LONGLEY SCD, P.E., CHAIR | PAMELA C. CREEDON P.E., BCEE, EXECUTIVE OFFICER

364 Knollcrest Drive, Suite 205, Redding, CA 96002 | www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralvalley

REGULATORY BACKGROUND

Central Valley Water Board enrolled the Facility under the General Order on 2 December 2014. The Amended Monitoring and Reporting Program requires the following:

- Influent Flow Rate, gallons per day (gpd). At a minimum total flow is measured monthly and reported quarterly.
- Dissolved oxygen measurement for each pond, mg/L, monthly.
- Freeboard measurement for each pond, 0.1 feet, monthly.
- Visual and auditory assessment of berm condition and odors.
- Effluent Biochemical Oxygen Demand from final pond, mg/L, monthly.
- Land application daily flow rate, gpd.
- Acreage applied, monthly.
- Local rainfall, inches, daily.
- Visual inspection for evidence of soil saturation/ponding, soil erosion, berm integrity, tailwater pump operation, nuisance odors/vectors, discharge offsite.

DISCHARGE DESCRIPTION

The California Pines Community Services District is a large recreational subdivision located on County Road 71, Modoc County. The facility consists of two separate areas and covers parts of approximately 60 sections in T39N, T40N, T41N, R10E and R11D, MDB&M in Modoc County. Domestic waste from the northern section of the subdivision, the Lake Units, is discharged to a wastewater system located on the west side of the subdivision. The southern section of the subdivision, the Hill Units, relies on individual septic tanks with leaching systems or (seasonal use) vault systems.

The wastewater collection, treatment and disposal system consists of over 15 miles of collection lines, five lift stations and five treatment and disposal ponds with a 48,000 gallon capacity. Much of the collection system relies on gravity flow. Currently the system serves 100 to 125 homes and a trailer park. Local surface water flows by intermittent drainage pathways to the Pit River.

This is an existing facility; therefore enrollment under the General Order is categorically exempt from the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) pursuant to California Code of Regulations, title 14, section 15301 which applies to ongoing or existing projects.

FACILITY SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

The Discharger will maintain exclusive control over the discharge, and shall comply with the terms and conditions of this Amended NOA and the General Order 2014-0153-DWQ-R5176, with all attachments.

- In accordance with the 2 December 2014 NOA, flow rates are generally less than 35,000 gpd, percolation rates of local soils are low, and the best available data show depth to groundwater is approximately 30 feet. Nitrogen monitoring is not required.
- Discharge of treated wastewater from the facility is prohibited outside of the temporary application period, 1 July 2017 through 1 October 2017, as authorized in the Amended NOA.
- Storm water runoff from the irrigation field shall not be discharged to any surface water drainage course within 30 days of the last wastewater application.
- Monitoring and reporting will be conducted as prescribed in the attached Amended MRP.

Additionally the General Order states in Section B.1.L that the Discharger shall comply with the setbacks as described in Table 3. This table summarizes different setback requirements for wastewater system equipment, activities, and storage and/or treatment ponds from sensitive receptors and property lines where applicable. The Discharger shall comply with the following applicable setback requirements as summarized in the following table.

Site Specific Applicable Setback Requirements					
Equipment or Activity	Domestic Well	Flowing Stream ^a	Ephemeral Stream Drainage ^b	Property Line	Lake or Reservoir ^d
Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System ^e	150 ft. ^y 100 ft. ^o 50 ft. ^c	50 ft. ^c	50 ft.	5 ft. ^c	200 ft. ^w 50 ft. ^c
Leach Field ^f	100 ft. ^{o,c}	100 ft. ^c	50 ft.	5 ft. ^c	200 ft. ^w 100 ft. ^c
LAND APPLICATION AREA REQUIREMENTS					
LAA (undisinfected secondary recycled water) ⁱ	150 ft. ^s	100 ft.	100 ft.	100 ft. ^x 50 ft. ^p	200 ft.
Spray Irrigation (disinfected tertiary recycled water) ^k	No spray irrigation of any recycled water, other than disinfected tertiary recycled water, shall take place within 100 feet of a residence or a place where public exposure could be similar to that of a park, playground, or school yard.				
WASTEWATER STORAGE AND/OR TREATMENT PONDS					
Impoundment (undisinfected secondary recycled water) ⁱ	150 ft. ^s	150 ft.	150 ft.	50 ft.	200 ft.
LAA denotes Land Application Area. Sec denotes secondary. ^a A flowing stream shall be measured from the ordinary high water mark established by fluctuations of water elevation and indicated by characteristics such as shelving, changes in soil character, vegetation type, presence of litter or debris, or other appropriate means. ^b Ephemeral Stream Drainage denotes a surface water drainage feature that flows only after rain or snow-melt and does not have sufficient groundwater seepage (baseflow) to maintain a condition of flowing surface water. The drainage shall be measured from a line that defines the limit of the ordinary high water mark (described in "a" above). Irrigation canals are not considered ephemeral streams drainage features. The ephemeral stream shall be a "losing stream" (discharging surface water to groundwater) at the proposed wastewater system site. ^c Setback established by California Plumbing Code, Table K-1. ^d Lake or reservoir boundary measured from the high water line. ^e Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System addresses equipment located below ground or that impedes leak detection by routine visual inspection. ^f Leach Field includes all subsurface dispersal systems, including mound systems except seepage pits. ⁱ Undisinfected secondary recycled water is defined in California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60301.900. ^k Additional restrictions for spray irrigation of recycled water are contained in California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60310(f) ^o California Well Standards, part II, section 8. Site-specific conditions may allow reduced setback or require an increased setback. See discussion in Well Standards. ^p Setback for drip or flood application methods. Spray irrigation is subject to additional setbacks and restrictions. (See footnote k.) ^s Setback established by California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60310(d). ^w Setback established by the Onsite Wastewater Treatment System Policy, section 7.5.5. ^x Setback established by California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60310(f).					

Failure to comply with the requirements in the documents could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code. Discharge of wastes other than those described in this NOA is prohibited. If the method of waste disposal changes from that described in this NOA, you must submit a new Report of Waste Discharge describing the new operation.

The required annual fee specified in the annual billing from the State Water Board shall be paid until this NOA is officially terminated. You must notify this office in writing if the discharge regulated by the General Order ceases, so that we may terminate coverage and avoid unnecessary billing.

The Central Valley Water Board has gone to a Paperless Office System. All regulatory documents, MRPs, submissions, materials, data, monitoring reports, and correspondence should be converted to a searchable Portable Document Format (PDF) and submitted electronically. Documents that are less than 50MB should be emailed to: centralvalleyredding@waterboards.ca.gov. Documents that are 50MB or larger should be transferred to a disc and mailed to the appropriate regional water board office, in this case 364 Knollcrest Drive, Suite 205, Redding, CA 96002. To ensure that your submittals are routed to the appropriate staff, the following information block should be included in any email used to transmit documents to this office:

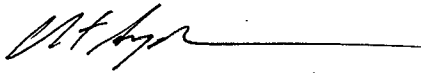
Program: WDR

WDID: 5A250102001

Facility Name: California Pines CSD

Order: 2014-0153-DWQ-R5176

If you have any questions regarding submitting an updated report of waste discharge, making changes to your permitted operations, compliance or enforcement please contact Monique Gaido at (530) 224-4205, Monique.gaido@waterboards.ca.gov, or the footer address.



(for) Pamela C. Creedon
Executive Officer

MEG: db

Attachments: Amended Monitoring and Reporting Program 2014-0153-DWQ-R5176
California Pines Community Services District Location Map
California Pines Community Services District Facility Map

cc w/o encls: Modoc County Environmental Health Division, Alturas
Tim O'Brien, State Water Board, Sacramento
Patrick Pulupa, SWRCB, Office of Chief Counsel, Sacramento